

Date: December 12, 2025

Author: William Joffe

Sprint Review and Retrospective

As the Scrum Master for the SNHU Travel project, I have arranged this Sprint Review and Retrospective to summarize the work we completed during our five-week development cycle and to draw conclusions on the effectiveness of the Scrum-Agile approach. Our mission was to develop and launch a digital travel agency website capable of offering trendy and niche vacation packages to expand the client base. Looking back at our work, it is clear that adopting the Scrum framework was the decisive factor that allowed us to navigate a tight deadline and shifting requirements without compromising the quality of the final deliverable.

In applying the Scrum-Agile principles, I observed how each distinct role specifically contributed to the success of the project. The Product Owner Christy acted as the voice of the customer and the primary driver of value. Her role was critical in defining the vision for the project, which she accomplished by creating the initial Product Backlog and detailing the Acceptance Criteria for every feature. We saw this in action during the creation of the User Stories where she explicitly defined the need for specific filtering options. The Developer Nicole focused on the execution and adaptability of the code. She was responsible for taking the user stories and turning them into functional software, and she demonstrated the flexibility of the role by rapidly implementing the sudden pivot to Detox and Wellness packages. The Product Tester Brian served as the quality gate for the application. His role went beyond simply finding bugs, as he actively participated in the validation of logic before code was even written. Finally, my role

as the Scrum Master was to act as a servant leader, ensuring the team adhered to the agreed-upon rules of behavior such as commitment and openness while removing any impediments that blocked their progress.

User Stories was the primary mechanism that helped our user stories come to completion because rather than relying on rigid requirement documents that are common in Waterfall methodologies, we utilized the standard user story format to keep the focus on the user and the value they receive. For example, User Story 2 regarding the Vacation Preference setting stated that as an end user, I want to set a vacation type in my profile so that I see only the packages that align with the type of vacation I want to take. This story was not just a sentence, but a conversation starter that included detailed acceptance criteria. The criteria specified that the list of vacation types must include options like Cruise, Museum Tours, and Eco-travel. This level of detail allowed the Product Tester to write a specific test case, Test-02-REV, which explicitly verified that these checkboxes existed and that the system properly saved the user's selection. Without the clarity provided by these stories and their acceptance criteria, the development and testing phases would have been misaligned.

One of the most significant advantages of our chosen methodology was how we handled interruptions. Midway through the project, there was a significant shift in direction when the stakeholders requested a focus on Detox and Wellness vacations. In a traditional Waterfall environment, this interruption would have been catastrophic. We would have been forced to halt development, scrap our previous requirements document, and restart the entire planning phase, likely missing our December deadline. However, the Scrum-Agile approach supported project completion despite this interruption.

Because we work in short sprints, the Product Owner was able to simply prioritize the backlog as they saw fit. The Developer then swapped the images and text strings for the new destinations without needing to tear down the entire architecture. We simply traded lower priority items in the backlog for the new wellness requirements, allowing the team to pivot immediately while keeping the project on track for the original release date.

Communication was another area where the Agile framework demonstrated its superiority over traditional methods. Our team charter established clear guidelines for communication, which included a daily stand-up meeting at 10 am. This quick meeting was vital for our ability to communicate effectively. During the project, the Developer identified issues with image resolutions on the new wellness packages. Instead of burying this information in a weekly report, she raised it immediately during the stand-up. This allowed our Tester Brian to update his test plan to focus on UI regression testing for different screen sizes that same day. Additionally, when the Tester found the logic for the Personalized Deal Offers in User Story 4 to be vague regarding climate definitions, he was able to reach out directly to the Product Owner for clarification. This direct line of communication ensured that we defined what constituted a tropical climate and how many past trips triggered the deal logic before hours were wasted coding the wrong thing.

The organizational tools we employed were equally as important for maintaining the pace required to meet our deadline. We utilized a Jira to host a Kanban board to track our work and ensure team transparency. This tool allowed the entire team to see the status of every item in real time. When the Developer pushed code updates, the status reflected immediately on the board, signaling to the Tester that the feature was ready for verification. This eliminated the need for long status meetings and email chains, as the board itself acted as the single source of truth. By

visualizing our work, we could identify bottlenecks early and ensure that the team remained focused on the Sprint Goal.

Evaluating the Agile process as a whole, it is pretty evident that this was the best approach for the SNHU Travel project. The effectiveness of using Agile principles was proven by our ability to deliver a working product in just five weeks. The pros of this approach included increased flexibility, higher visibility of sprint progress, and earlier detection of quality issues. The ability to inspect and adapt during the Sprint Review and Retrospective meant that we were constantly improving our process. If we had chosen a Waterfall approach, the rigid structure would have made the mid-project pivot impossible to handle within our timeline. The documentation requirements alone could have covered the first two weeks of our schedule. Agile allowed us to focus on building working software rather than comprehensive documentation which would have ended up changing later anyway.

For future projects at SNHU Travel, I recommend continuing with the Agile approach. The collaboration between the Product Owner, Developer, and Tester, facilitated by the Scrum Master, created a cohesive unit that had autonomy to get work done faster. By respecting the roles and adhering to the ceremonies like the Daily Scrum and Sprint Review, we ensured that every team member was aligned with the business goals. The success of the Vacation Preference and Price Filtering features, verified by test cases and driven by clear user stories, stands as proof that this methodology delivers value to the customer faster and more reliably than the alternatives while simultaneously keeping the project within the budget constraints.